

- Use snow tires or chains when it's required.
- During winter months, you can improve traction by adding chains to your tires or changing to studded tires.

Avoid icy roads as much as possible. If you must drive on icy roads, slow down and leave extra space around your vehicle.

- On cold, wet days, shady spots can be icy.
- Overpasses and other types of bridges can have icy spots even when the rest of the road doesn't.
- When below-freezing temperatures warm up to near-freezing, ice can melt and become wet. This makes the road more slippery.
- *Black ice* refers to a thin coating of ice that is hard for drivers to see. Even if you don't see ice, pay attention when driving in temperatures near or below freezing. Many drivers crash when they lose control of their vehicles on black ice.

SKIDDING

Skids are caused when the tires can no longer grip the road. High speeds and slippery roads increase the possibility of skidding if you turn or stop suddenly. Because you cannot control a vehicle when it's skidding, it's best to avoid skidding in the first place.

If you're skidding, do the following:

1. **Take your foot off the accelerator.**
2. **Press or pump your brakes.** Antilock brakes will help control the rotation of the wheels to slow down faster. They will also allow you to continue steering the vehicle. If you don't have antilock brakes, quickly pressing the brake pedal down could cause you to skid more.

